2023年12月四级真题第2套

年份 2023 | 月份 12 | 第 二 套 | 时长 125 分钟 | 满分 710（及格 425）

听力 (Listening)

Section A news

短新闻

🎧 听力音频：audio/SectionA.mp3（请使用离线包 papers 目录下对应 audio 文件夹播放）

1. **Why did the police officer stop the SUV car?**

   A. He noticed the driver was too young to drive.

   B. He found there was no one sitting at the wheel.

   C. He thought something must be wrong with the driver.

   D. He saw the driver changing lanes much too frequently.

2. **What did the boy tell the police officers he was planning to do?**

   A. Buy a sports car.

   B. Drive across town.

   C. Leave California.

   D. Visit his sister.

3. **What does the report say we have not yet understood about mobile phones?**

   A. How they change the way we shop.

   B. How they alter human skeletons.

   C. How they cause increased headaches.

   D. How they affect our communication.

4. **What happens to the skin when rubbed or pressed constantly?**

   A. It loosens.

   B. It brightens.

   C. It hardens.

   D. It softens.

5. **What is the village going to do for the cat named Wilbur?**

   A. Create Internet pages for him.

   B. Ask a local pet shop to adopt him.

   C. Name an orange tree after him.

   D. Hold a birthday party for him.

6. **What do we learn from the report about the cat?**

A. He is a bold and aggressive pet.

B. He pays regular visits to village shops.

C. He once bit a doctor s receptionist.

D. He often seeks food from strangers.

7. **What does the pub owner Leslie Harper say about the cat?**

A. He is fond of luxury cat food.

B. He likes to stay in villagers’ houses.

C. He knows everybody in the village.

D. He often seeks food around her pub.

Section B conversations

长对话

🎧 听力音频：audio/SectionB.mp3（请使用离线包 papers 目录下对应 audio 文件夹播放）

1. **What's are the speakers talking about in this conversation?**

   A. Who to order the food.

   B. Whether to have sandwiches.

   C. When to go for their meal.

   D. Where to have their lunch.

2. **Where did the speakers see Bridget Clark the famous movie star?**

   A. In the shopping center nearby.

   B. In the expensive Italian style diner.

   C. At the Sandwich Place on Camden Street.

   D. At the American restaurant they frequent.

3. **Why does the woman say she needs to get back by 2030?**

   A. There is to be a conference call.

   B. She has to meet with her boss then.

   C. There will be crowds of people waiting for her.

   D. She will have a photo taken with Brigette Clark.

4. **Why does the woman say Jeremy should throw his soup in the bin?**

   A. She knows Jeremy dislikes having soup for lunch.

   B. She doesn’ t think his wife cooks well.

   C. She feels Jeremy would rather dine out.

   D. She has found the soup smells terrible.

5. **Who is the man talking to in the conversation?**

   A. A landlady.

   B. A waitress.

   C. A receptionist.

   D. A saleswoman.

6. **What do we learn about the man's father-in-law from the conversation?**

A. He was involved in a terrible car accident last April.

B. He has much difficulty getting up and down stairs.

C. He is expected to undergo a knee operation.

D. He prefers to stay next door to the children.

7. **Why does the man say they will explore all the options available?**

A. To please his parents- in-law.

B. To find the best trip for his kids.

C. To satisfy his curiosity.

D. To compare prices.

8. **What does the woman suggest the man and his family do close to the end of the conversation?**

A. Visit a local art gallery.

B. Go on a boat trip.

C. Take some photos of the islands.

D. Try her hand-made clothing.

Section C passages

听力篇章

🎧 听力音频：audio/SectionC.mp3（请使用离线包 papers 目录下对应 audio 文件夹播放）

1. **What does the passive say about artificial intelligence agents?**

   A. They are more intelligent than many of us.

   B. They have already become our new friends.

   C. They have begun to affect our social behavior.

   D. They play increasingly more important roles.

2. **What does the new study want to find out about using an artificial intelligence agents?**

   A. Whether it might have any effect on the way we negotiate.

   B. Whether it might actually outperform human negotiators.

   C. Whether it can facilitate business transactions.

   D. Whether it can speed up legal procedures.

3. **What did participants tend to do when assigned an AI agent to negotiate on their behalf.**

   A. Choose to be tough.

   B. Sympathize with their opponent.

   C. Use deceptive strategies.

   D. Appear to be pleasant.

4. **What do we learn about the benefits the participants gained from the healthy cooking course?**

   A. They were perceived differently by some academics.

   B. They still existed six months after the course ended.

   C. They varied greatly among the course participants.

   D. They were only measurable within seven weeks.

5. **What do the new research findings suggest about mental health benefits?**

   A. They can be easily seen among participants in a healthy weight range.

   B. They are related to participants’ initial cooking skills.

   C. They are linked to cooking confidence and cooking satisfaction.

   D. They actually result from eating more fruits and vegetables.

6. **What plays a role in determining who benefits most from learning to cook?**

   A. Gender.

   B. Confidence.

   C. Health.

   D. Practice.

7. **What does research show about our personal space?**

   A. It keeps others away.

   B. It causes discomfort.

   C. It remains visible.

   D. It varies in size.

8. **What happens if a mere acquaintance enters our intimate space?**

   A. It makes us feel uncomfortable.

   B. It renders the acquaintance a stranger.

   C. It brings the acquaintance closer to us.

   D. It causes the bubble around us to vanish.

9. **Where the people feel comfortable interacting with new acquaintances or strangers.**

   A. In personal space.

   B. In social space.

   C. Within a distance of 18 inches.

   D. Over 2 feet away from one another.

10. **When are the sizes of our personal bubbles fixed?**

    A. When we begin to feel fear.

    B. When we develop a sense of space.

    C. When we are 3 or 4 years old.

    D. When we enter our teens.

阅读 (Reading)

Section A word_fill

选词填空

A number of studies have looked at how family life can affect productivity and satisfaction in the workplace. However, there has been __26__ little research on the influence of leisure activities. So Ciara Kelly and colleagues recruited 129 hobbyists to look at how the time spent on their hobbies __27__ their work life.

The researchers found that when participants spent longer than __28__ on their leisure activity, their belief in their ability to perform their job was strengthened. But this was only the __29__ when they had a serious hobby that was dissimilar to their job, or when their hobby was similar to their work but they only did it __30__. When their hobby was both serious and similar to their job, then spending more time on it actually decreased their work __31__.

Why might that be? To maintain a serious hobby, people need to invest significant psychological resources, say the authors—so if the activity has the same kinds of demands as their work, they may be left __32__ and unable to perform well at their job. But if their hobby is quite different from their career, it may not __33__ in the same way but instead help them develop other knowledge and skills that can __34__ their confidence at work. "Consider a scientist who is a keen rock climber," says Kelly. "Since climbing is so far __35__ from their day-to-day work activities, they can still recover from the demands of their job with plenty of resources."

Word Bank:

- boost
- case
- casually
- efficiency
- estate
- exhausted
- faculty
- interfere
- normal
- prevalent
- relative
- removed
- scratch
- shaped
- surprisingly

Section B paragraph_matching

段落匹配

Section C reading_comprehension

阅读理解

写作 (Writing)

Directions: the university newspaper is inviting submissions from the students for its coming edition on the recent development in their hometown. You are now to write an essay for submission. You will have 30 minutes to write the essay. You should write at least 120 words but no more than 180 words.

建议时间：30 分钟 | 字数：120-180 | 分值：15

作答区

翻译 (Translation)

Directions: For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on Answer Sheet 2.

改革开放以来， 中国人的饮食(diet)发生了 显著变化。 过去由于经济落后， 食品种类有限、 数 量不足， 人们仅仅满足于吃得饱。 如今中国经济快速发展， 食品不仅更加丰富多样， 质量也大幅 提高。 随着生活水平不断提升， 人们对饮食的要求越来越高， 更加注重吃得营养健康。 因此， 目 前市场上推出的低脂、 低糖、 有机食品受到人们的普遍欢迎。

建议时间：30 分钟 | 分值：15

作答区

听力原文 / Transcripts

News Transcript (EN)

1
00:00:00,000 --> 00:00:24,480
College English Test, Band 4, Part 2, Listening Comprehension, Section A, Directions. In this section, you will hear three news reports. At the end of each news report, you will hear two or three questions. Both the news report and the questions will be spoken only once.

2
00:00:24,480 --> 00:00:31,000
After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked

3
00:00:31,000 --> 00:00:39,380
A, B, C, and D. Then mark the corresponding letter on answer sheet 1 with a single line

4
00:00:39,380 --> 00:00:40,540
through the center.

5
00:00:42,040 --> 00:00:49,080
News reports 1. A police officer in the US stopped a large SUV car that was going very

6
00:00:49,080 --> 00:00:54,460
slowly and drifting across lanes on a highway. He expected to find a driver who

7
00:00:54,460 --> 00:01:01,680
was either very drunk or having a medical emergency. Instead, the officer discovered a five-year-old

8
00:01:01,680 --> 00:01:07,600
boy sat on the edge of the driver's seat. His feet could barely reach the break, and

9
00:01:07,600 --> 00:01:13,120
his head was only just high enough to see out of the windows. The child had taken the keys

10
00:01:13,120 --> 00:01:19,120
to the family car while his teenage sister was napping. He then drove three kilometers

11
00:01:19,120 --> 00:01:25,500
across town before getting on the highway. The boy later told confused officers that he

12
00:01:25,500 --> 00:01:31,520

was planning to travel to California and by a Lamborghini sports car. Although he only

13
00:01:31,520 --> 00:01:36,080
had three dollars in his wallet, at least he was driving in the right direction.

14
00:01:37,560 --> 00:01:41,980
Questions 1 and 2 are based on the news report you have just heard?

15
00:01:41,980 --> 00:01:49,200
Question 1. Why did the police officer stop the SUV car?

16
00:02:02,980 --> 00:02:08,800
Question 2. What did the boy tell the police officers he was planning to do?

17
00:02:23,920 --> 00:02:32,200
News Report 2 Mobile phones have changed the way we live, how we read, work, communicate,

18
00:02:32,840 --> 00:02:39,760
and shop. But we already know this. What we have not yet understood is the way that

19
00:02:39,760 --> 00:02:46,260
Many machines in front of us are changing our skeletons. Possibly altering not just the

20
00:02:46,260 --> 00:02:49,780
way we behave, but even the very shape of our bodies.

21
00:02:51,180 --> 00:02:56,540
New scientific research at the University of the Sunshine Coast in Queensland, Australia,

22
00:02:57,460 --> 00:03:02,980
suggests that young people are developing extra pieces of bone at the backs of their heads.

23
00:03:03,740 --> 00:03:08,760
These pieces of bone are caused by the way people bend their heads when they use the

24
00:03:09,580 --> 00:03:15,880
This shifts weight onto the muscles at the back of the head and causes the bone to grow

25

00:03:15,880 --> 00:03:22,080
in a way that is not normal. This process can be compared to the way the skin heartens

26
00:03:22,080 --> 00:03:28,760
in response to constant rubbing or pressure. The result is a piece of bone like a horn

27
00:03:28,760 --> 00:03:31,580
that sticks out from the head by the neck.

28
00:03:32,700 --> 00:03:38,020
Question 3 and 4 are based on the news report you have just heard.

29
00:03:38,960 --> 00:03:39,920
Question 3.

30
00:03:40,640 --> 00:03:45,420
What does the report say we have not yet understood about mobile phones?

31
00:04:00,260 --> 00:04:06,340
Question 4. What happens to the skin when rubbed or pressed constantly?

32
00:04:21,559 --> 00:04:29,080
New Report 3 A village is going to throw a birthday party for an orange cat's named Wilbur,

33
00:04:29,480 --> 00:04:36,000
who has become famous for making a regular appearance at local shops. Wilbur has his own internet

34
00:04:36,000 --> 00:04:43,440
pages as he approaches his tenth birthday on July 7. Wilbur is both bold and friendly.

35
00:04:43,440 --> 00:04:49,760
He spends most of his time in shops and businesses around the village, he'll just take

36
00:04:49,760 --> 00:04:55,580
himself into any shop anywhere. There was one time when the doctors receptionist came

37
00:04:55,580 --> 00:05:01,720
back and he was sitting on her chair. Among his favourite haunts are a local hairdresser,

38
00:05:02,160 --> 00:05:04,760
two pubs, and the knotting and primary school.

39
00:05:05,780 --> 00:05:11,160
Leslie Harper, who runs one of the pubs, said the cat has been a big hit with their

40
00:05:12,260 --> 00:05:16,800
He's been a regular visitor for most of this year, she told the press association.

41
00:05:17,700 --> 00:05:22,760
He's a very relaxed cat, happy for customers and villagers young and old to come in and

42
00:05:22,760 --> 00:05:23,340
say hello.

43
00:05:24,360 --> 00:05:30,360
She also said he is a cat of expensive tastes, who likes his high priced cat food.

44
00:05:31,180 --> 00:05:37,140
Sarah Godfrey, who is organizing Wilbur's party, told the local newspaper, Wilbur is part

45
00:05:37,140 --> 00:05:41,060
our lives as he is for everyone who lives in the village.

46
00:06:08,559 --> 00:06:13,400
Question 6. What do we learn from the report about the cat?

47
00:06:28,000 --> 00:06:33,840
Question 7. What does the pub owner Leslie Harper say about the cat?

Conversations (EN)

1
00:00:01,700 --> 00:00:17,920
Section B, Directions. In this section you will hear two long conversations. At the end of each conversation, you will hear four questions. Both the conversation and the questions will be spoken only once.

2
00:00:17,920 --> 00:00:24,380
After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices, marked

3
00:00:24,380 --> 00:00:32,680
A, B, C, and D. Then, mark the corresponding letter on answer sheet 1 with a single line

4
00:00:32,680 --> 00:00:36,800
through the center. Conversation 1.

5
00:00:37,480 --> 00:00:39,460
So, where do you want to go for lunch?

6
00:00:40,040 --> 00:00:42,220
I don't know. Do you have anything in mind?

7
00:00:42,840 --> 00:00:45,600
What about the sandwich place on Camden Street?

8
00:00:46,680 --> 00:00:53,720
Hmm,no, sorry. I don't feel like sandwiches today. It's a great place, but I think we go there too often.

9
00:00:54,260 --> 00:00:58,940
That's true. Remember that's where we saw Bridget Clark, the famous movie star.

10
00:00:59,360 --> 00:01:05,760
Of course, how could I ever forget? There were crowds of people around her asking for a photo with her.

11
00:01:06,260 --> 00:01:10,780
What about Hamburg, is then? Does that American style diner on the way to the mall?

12
00:01:10,780 --> 00:01:16,880
I like that place. Their chips are great, but their service takes a long time, and I need

13
00:01:16,880 --> 00:01:23,060
to get back by 230 for a conference call. How about trying something new? We could try

14
00:01:23,640 --> 00:01:28,740
Mario's, the new Italian restaurant on the corner. It looks alright. Have you been there?

15
00:01:29,100 --> 00:01:34,200
No, I haven't, but I've noticed that it has great reviews on the internet. It's supposed

16
00:01:34,200 --> 00:01:39,120
to be one of the best Italians in town. I think Jeremy has been there, and said it was amazing.

17
00:01:39,120 --> 00:01:41,100
I'm up for that.

18
00:01:41,360 --> 00:01:44,360
Cool. Have you asked Jeremy if he would like to come with us?

19
00:01:44,700 --> 00:01:49,980
I already have. He says he can't. He has brought his own lunch today, so he will stay in.

20
00:01:50,340 --> 00:01:52,000
I think his wife made him soup.

21
00:01:52,620 --> 00:01:58,700
Poor Jeremy. His wife is a terrible cook. He should throw that soup in the bin and join us.

22
00:02:00,120 --> 00:02:04,680
Questions 8 to 11 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

23
00:02:04,680 --> 00:02:10,940
Question 8. What's are the speakers talking about in this conversation?

24
00:02:25,380 --> 00:02:30,960
Question 9. Where did the speakers see Bridget Clark the famous movie star?

25
00:02:46,400 --> 00:02:51,580

Question 10. Why does the woman say she needs to get back by 230?

26
00:03:06,799 --> 00:03:12,520
Question 11. Why does the woman say Jeremy should throw his soup in the bin?

27
00:03:28,579 --> 00:03:29,620
Conversation 2

28
00:03:29,620 --> 00:03:33,860
Hi there, how are you today? Do you have a reservation with us already?

29
00:03:34,480 --> 00:03:41,640
Good afternoon! Yes! We reserved our rooms yesterday morning on your website for 3 nights, the names Patterson.

30
00:03:42,000 --> 00:03:47,220
Okay, let me have a look. Yes, we have it here. You brought the whole family with you, I see.

31
00:03:47,220 --> 00:03:51,680
Yes, the two kids my wife and I, and her parents too.

32
00:03:51,960 --> 00:03:52,240
Great.

33
00:03:52,880 --> 00:03:58,580
So we have a family room for you and your wife and the kids, and another double room for

34
00:03:58,580 --> 00:03:59,600
your parents and law.

35
00:04:00,100 --> 00:04:04,140
They are right next to each other on the ground floor, since you mentioned in your

36
00:04:04,140 --> 00:04:06,240
message that they have trouble with stairs.

37
00:04:06,600 --> 00:04:07,360
That's wonderful.

38
00:04:07,880 --> 00:04:12,740
My father-in-law has had terrible problems getting up and down stairs since his new operation

39
00:04:12,740 --> 00:04:13,520
last April.

40
00:04:13,520 --> 00:04:19,040
I'm sorry to hear that, and if you need any help to find transportation for the whole family,

41
00:04:19,420 --> 00:04:21,880
we can definitely recommend someone for you.

42
00:04:22,200 --> 00:04:27,020
We were thinking of renting a car, but we will explore all the options available for sure.

43
00:04:27,300 --> 00:04:30,580
So yes, that would be very helpful in comparing prices.

44
00:04:31,120 --> 00:04:34,140
We're also wondering what tours and day trips are available.

45
00:04:34,600 --> 00:04:36,860
We have a bunches of brochures here.

46
00:04:37,300 --> 00:04:39,620
I would recommend getting out on a boat trip.

47
00:04:39,620 --> 00:04:44,100
The kids will love it, and there are so many islands nearby to explore.

48
00:04:44,620 --> 00:04:50,900
There's also a great night market for their into town that has all kinds of food and cool little shops,

49
00:04:51,200 --> 00:04:55,320
selling souvenirs and local jewelry, and clothing made by hand.

50
00:04:56,200 --> 00:04:57,480
That all sounds marvelous.

51
00:04:58,600 --> 00:05:05,260
Now all I need is to photocopy your passports, and then I can get you all checked in and show you to your rooms.

52
00:05:05,260 --> 00:05:11,520
Questions 12 to 15 are based on the conversation you have just heard.

53
00:05:12,240 --> 00:05:16,820
Question 12 Who is the man talking to in the conversation?

54
00:05:31,980 --> 00:05:37,760
Question 13. What do we learn about the man's father-in-law from the conversation?

55
00:05:52,860 --> 00:05:58,900
Question 14. Why does the man say they will explore all the options available?

56
00:06:14,120 --> 00:06:20,280
Question 15. What does the woman suggest the man and his family do close to the end of

57
00:06:20,280 --> 00:06:20,880
the conversation?

Passages (EN)

1
00:00:01,140 --> 00:00:15,880
Section C, directions. In this section you will hear three passages. At the end of each passage you will hear three or four questions. Both the passage and the questions will be spoken only once.

2
00:00:15,880 --> 00:00:21,740
After you hear a question, you must choose the best answer from the four choices marked

3
00:00:21,740 --> 00:00:30,760
A, B, C and D. Then mark the corresponding letter on Ansuchit 1 with a single line through

4
00:00:30,760 --> 00:00:31,640
the center.

5
00:00:32,880 --> 00:00:40,180
Passage 1. Artificial intelligence agents play ever more influential roles in our lives.

6
00:00:40,180 --> 00:00:45,220
They do everything from suggesting new friends to recommending purchases.

7
00:00:46,380 --> 00:00:48,500
They're even beginning to drive our cars.

8
00:00:49,500 --> 00:00:57,660
Another role that they are expected to take over is negotiating on our behalf in commercial transactions or legal disputes.

9
00:00:58,620 --> 00:01:05,099
So, it's important to know whether using an artificial intelligence agent might affect how we negotiate.

10
00:01:06,220 --> 00:01:08,260
Research indicates that it does.

11
00:01:08,260 --> 00:01:14,120
In a new study, participants were told to imagine that they were negotiating for something

12
00:01:14,120 --> 00:01:16,200

important to them, like a house.

13
00:01:16,900 --> 00:01:22,880
Next, they were told either that they would negotiate for themselves, or they would program

14
00:01:22,880 --> 00:01:26,620
an artificial intelligence agent to negotiate for them.

15
00:01:27,140 --> 00:01:33,680
Participants then completed a survey, indicating how tough, deceptive, and pleasant or otherwise

16
00:01:33,680 --> 00:01:35,020
they wanted to be.

17
00:01:35,020 --> 00:01:38,100
or one of their agent to be in the negotiations.

18
00:01:39,440 --> 00:01:46,860
For example, participants could choose to be tough by making an opening demand far greater than what they'd be willing to accept.

19
00:01:47,980 --> 00:01:52,240
They could also choose to express sympathy with their opponent to appear pleasant.

20
00:01:53,300 --> 00:02:00,660
But they could also indicate that day or their agent would strategically express anger toward the opponent to gain advantage.

21
00:02:00,660 --> 00:02:07,040
or they could opt to convey dissatisfaction with the encounter so that the other party

22
00:02:07,040 --> 00:02:12,440
would think they were losing interest. These are both examples of deceptive strategies.

23
00:02:13,600 --> 00:02:18,720
Participants were more willing to employ deceptive strategies when assigned an agent to

24
00:02:18,720 --> 00:02:26,560
negotiate on their behalf. Questions 16 to 18 are based on the passage you have just heard.

25
00:02:26,560 --> 00:02:33,300
Question 16. What does the passive say about artificial intelligence agents?

26
00:02:48,120 --> 00:02:54,680
Question 17. What does the new study want to find out about using an artificial intelligence

27
00:02:54,680 --> 00:02:55,660
agents.

28
00:03:10,700 --> 00:03:17,140
Question 18. What did participants tend to do when assigned an AI agent to negotiate

29
00:03:17,140 --> 00:03:18,940
on their behalf.

30
00:03:33,740 --> 00:03:35,100
Passage 2

31
00:03:35,100 --> 00:03:40,080
New research has studied the effects of a seven week healthy cooking course.

32
00:03:40,740 --> 00:03:45,800
Acid anics measured the program's effect on cooking confidence and self-proceed mental

33
00:03:45,800 --> 00:03:46,340
health.

34
00:03:46,340 --> 00:03:52,900
Researchers also measured participants overall satisfaction around cooking and diet related

35
00:03:52,900 --> 00:03:55,420
behaviours. What were the findings?

36
00:03:56,340 --> 00:04:02,300
Course participants saw significance improvements in general health. They also reported improved

37
00:04:02,300 --> 00:04:09,100

mental health and subjective vitality immediately after the program. These benefits remained

38
00:04:09,100 --> 00:04:11,900
six months after the completion of the course.

39
00:04:11,900 --> 00:04:18,440
What caused these improvements? Researchers have previously found a link between eating more fruits

40
00:04:18,440 --> 00:04:24,620
and vegetables and improved longer-term mental health. This would imply that the participants

41
00:04:24,620 --> 00:04:31,400
in the current study may have felt better due to improved diet. However, the study showed

42
00:04:31,400 --> 00:04:36,940
participants mental health improved even if their reported diets did not change after

43
00:04:36,940 --> 00:04:43,540
completing the program. Also, the mental health benefits were equal among participants who

44
00:04:43,540 --> 00:04:50,020
are overweight or obese and those in a healthy weight range. This suggests a link between

45
00:04:50,020 --> 00:04:55,080
cooking confidence and satisfaction around cooking and mental health benefits.

46
00:04:56,260 --> 00:05:01,980
Who benefits most from learning to cook? Gender plays a part. At the start of the program,

47
00:05:01,980 --> 00:05:10,380
77% of female participants were confident about cooking, but just 23% of males were confident.

48
00:05:11,180 --> 00:05:16,560
At the end of the program, cooking confidence and skills were equal across both counterparts.

49
00:05:19,240 --> 00:05:23,220
This changing confidence could lead to a gender balance in home cooking.

50

00:05:23,960 --> 00:05:29,440
This in turn could reduce consumption of unhealthy high calorie processed meals.

51
00:05:29,440 --> 00:05:43,020
Question 19. Question 19. Question 19. What do we learn about the benefits the participants gained from the healthy cooking course?

52
00:05:57,680 --> 00:06:04,300
Question 20. What do the new research findings suggest about mental health benefits?

53
00:06:19,400 --> 00:06:26,820
Question 21. What plays a role in determining who benefits most from learning to cook?

54
00:06:40,940 --> 00:06:45,240
Passage 3 What is personal space?

55
00:06:45,940 --> 00:06:51,380
We often think of it as an invisible bubble of space surrounding us that others can't

56
00:06:51,380 --> 00:06:53,660
enter without causing discomfort.

57
00:06:53,660 --> 00:06:58,960
Research shows, however, that we actually have bubbles of different sizes.

58
00:06:59,760 --> 00:07:03,080
Each of these bubbles applies to a different set of people.

59
00:07:04,100 --> 00:07:11,440
The smallest zone, called intimate space, extends outward from our bodies, 18 inches in every

60
00:07:11,440 --> 00:07:12,100
direction.

61
00:07:13,360 --> 00:07:18,260
Only family, pets, and one's closest friends may enter it.

62
00:07:18,260 --> 00:07:22,940
Amir acquaintance entering our intimate space makes us uncomfortable.

63
00:07:24,440 --> 00:07:31,800
Next is the bubble called personal space, extending from 1.5 feet to 4 feet away.

64
00:07:32,460 --> 00:07:39,580
Friends and acquaintances can comfortably occupy this zone, especially during informal conversations,

65
00:07:40,300 --> 00:07:41,800
but strangers are forbidden.

66
00:07:41,800 --> 00:07:47,740
Extending from 4 to 12 feet away from us is social space.

67
00:07:48,480 --> 00:07:53,900
Here people feel comfortable conducting routine social interactions with new acquaintances

68
00:07:53,900 --> 00:07:55,360
or total strangers.

69
00:07:56,940 --> 00:08:01,080
Those are the average sizes of Americans' personal bubbles, anyway.

70
00:08:01,720 --> 00:08:08,000
It is important to keep in mind that personal space varies depending on culture and context.

71
00:08:08,000 --> 00:08:15,760
Furthermore, there are significant individual differences. As we all know, cultural or individual

72
00:08:15,760 --> 00:08:21,420
differences in personal bubble diameters are all too often the cause of discomfort.

73
00:08:22,520 --> 00:08:28,640
How do these personal bubbles arise? According to research, we begin to develop our individual

74
00:08:28,640 --> 00:08:35,960
sense of personal space around age 3 or 4. The sizes of our bubbles are fixed by our

75
00:08:35,960 --> 00:08:42,799

These bubbles are constructed and monitored by the brain region involved in fear.

76
00:08:44,080 --> 00:08:48,820
Questions 22-25 are based on the passage you have just heard.

77
00:08:49,460 --> 00:08:50,200
Question 22.

78
00:08:51,160 --> 00:08:54,300
What does research show about our personal space?

79
00:09:08,980 --> 00:09:15,600
Question 23 What happens if a mere acquaintance enters our intimate space?

80
00:09:30,300 --> 00:09:36,780
Question 24. Where the people feel comfortable interacting with new acquaintances or

81
00:09:50,120 --> 00:09:51,520
strangers.

82
00:09:51,520 --> 00:09:56,640
Question 25 When are the sizes of our bubbles fixed?

83
00:10:11,840 --> 00:10:14,200
That's the end of listening comprehension.